The Burning of Zozobra

Presented by the Kiwanis Club of Santa Fe

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Albuquerque Journal

Dear Friends at Albuquerque Journal,

Every September in Santa Fe, New Mexico, more than 50,000 people gather in the dark to burn a 50-foot marionette named Zozobra, "Old Man Gloom," stuffed with the worries, regrets and bad news of the past year. The artist Will Shuster built the first one in 1924. Today the Burning of Zozobra is one of the oldest and best-loved community celebrations in the American West: part theater, part bonfire, and a once-a-year release for an entire region. I'd like to invite your company to be part of the 103rd.

The audience is bigger than the park. The 2026 burn drew 49,732 people in person and a total audience of 1,265,932, the largest in the event's history, through a statewide broadcast and livestream with our partner KOAT-TV, Albuquerque's ABC affiliate. Our website logged 1.8 million visits last year, and our Facebook posts reached 7.1 million people. The 100th burning in 2024 drew guests from all 50 states and 24 countries.

On Friday, September 3, 2027, Zozobra returns as Zozobra the Kid, every Old West villain rolled into one: the card shark, the claim jumper, the snake oil salesman. It is a natural stage for any brand with roots in the Southwest, and a theme our audience has asked us for for years.

Zozobra is the heart of a full year of celebrations produced by the volunteer Kiwanis Club of Santa Fe. Zozobra the Balloon, a 135-foot hot air balloon in Old Man Gloom's image, flies at the Albuquerque International Balloon Fiesta and at rallies in Colorado, Texas and Arizona. Día de los Muertos on the Santa Fe Plaza drew 46,891 people in 2025, and we also produce New Year's Eve on the Plaza and Santa Fe's Fourth of July.

What sets these events apart is who they serve. They are run entirely by volunteers, children 10 and under get into Zozobra free, and General Admission stays at $30 with no fees. Once the bills are paid, net proceeds go to grants for nonprofits serving New Mexico's children. Over the years Kiwanis has returned $3.2 million to New Mexico youth.

For a regional or national partner, I would recommend a Zozobra the Balloon RC Balloon sponsorship at $5,000. He flew five times at the 2026 Albuquerque International Balloon Fiesta. You are the named sponsor at the radio-controlled balloon rally of your choice and on burnzozobra.com, and it includes a radio-controlled Zozobra balloon inflation at your company event, a place on the crew at balloon events, a company photo op, your banner at the Burning of Zozobra, and two Premium Viewing seats for the 103rd Burning. We would gladly take part or all of it as a media trade.

Sponsors who commit by Friday, January 15, 2027, will be in our full spring campaign when tickets go on sale Tuesday, April 13, 2027. The full **2027 sponsorship deck** and the **Zozobra the Balloon deck** lay out every level, and you can **apply online** in a few minutes and pay by credit card, check or invoice.

I would welcome a short call to learn about your company's goals and tailor a partnership to them. You can reach me directly at 206-719-9652 or **burnhim@burnzozobra.com**. Thank you for considering it, and I hope to welcome you to Santa Fe in September.

¡Viva el Viejo!



Raymond G. Sandoval, Esq.
Zozobra Event Chairman